

The AI *Starter Kit*

Stop using AI like a search engine. One formula, ten prompts and a cheat sheet that turn it into the assistant you've been told it could be.

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Why your AI answers feel generic

Most people type into AI the way they type into Google. Short in, generic out. AI isn't a search box — it's closer to a sharp new colleague who knows nothing about you yet. Brief it like one.

THE SEARCH-ENGINE HABIT

 write a cover letter



WHAT COMES BACK

"Dear Hiring Manager, I am writing to express my interest in the Project Coordinator position. I am a hardworking team player with strong communication skills and a passion for..."

Could be anyone's

THE BRIEFING HABIT

ROLE	Act as a recruiter who has read 10,000 cover letters
CONTEXT	6 years in retail, applying for a hospital project coordinator role
TASK	Connect my experience to this role
FORMAT	Under 250 words, warm, no clichés



WHAT COMES BACK

"Six years of Saturday rushes taught me what hospitals already know: schedules break, and people get upset when they do. I kept a 40-person team staffed through every holiday rush..."

Sounds like you

Same AI, same request. The only difference is the briefing.

Anatomy of a great prompt

Four parts. You don't need all four every time — but the more you give, the better it gets.

1 Role	Act as a recruiter who has read 10,000 cover letters.	<i>Who should it be?</i>
2 Context	I'm applying for a project coordinator role at a hospital. I've spent six years in retail management, and I'm good at scheduling and calming upset customers.	<i>What does it need to know?</i>
3 Task	Write a cover letter that connects my retail experience to this role without apologizing for it.	<i>One clear job</i>
4 Format	Keep it under 250 words, warm but confident, and skip clichés like "I am writing to express my interest."	<i>What should it look like?</i>

Four habits that matter more than the perfect prompt

Keep talking.

The first answer is a draft. Reply "shorter" or "sound more like me."

Give it your material.

Paste the posting, the email thread, your notes.

Let it ask you.

End with "Ask me questions before you start."

Check the facts.

AI can sound certain and still be wrong. Verify what matters.

Ten prompts worth keeping

Swap the **[highlighted]** parts for your details. On a phone, tap the link under each prompt to open a copy-ready version.



01 The “Interview Me First”

ANY TASK

The single biggest upgrade. Instead of guessing, the AI pulls the context out of you.

I want help with **[the task — e.g. planning my kid's birthday / writing a LinkedIn post / fixing my budget]**. Before you give me anything, ask me up to 5 questions, one at a time, that you need answered to do this really well. After my last answer, give me your best version.

You get: A tailored plan built from your answers

Copy it: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p1



02 Explain It Like I'm New

LEARNING

Learn anything — a new job skill, a medical bill, a lease — without feeling dumb.

Explain **[topic]** to me like I'm smart but completely new to it. Use one everyday analogy, then give me the 3 things that actually matter and the 1 mistake beginners make. Finish with a 3-question quiz so I know I've got it.

You get: A plain-English explanation + a quick quiz

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03 The Resume Bullet Upgrade

JOB SEARCH

Turns “responsible for” duties into results a hiring manager actually notices.

Act as a hiring manager for **[target job title]**. Here are bullets from my resume: **[paste bullets]**. Rewrite each one to lead with a strong verb and show a result. Where a number would help and I haven't given one, ask me for it — don't invent it. Show before and after side by side.

You get: Before-and-after resume bullets

Copy it: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p3

Why “don't invent it” matters: AI will happily make up impressive numbers. Recruiters ask about them in interviews.



04 The Job Posting Decoder

JOB SEARCH

See what a posting is really asking for — and exactly where you match.

Here's a job posting: **[paste posting]**. And here's my resume: **[paste resume]**. Give me: (1) the 5 things this employer cares about most, in plain English, (2) where I'm a strong match, with proof from my resume, (3) my honest gaps and how I could address each one in my application.

You get: Top 5 priorities, your matches and gaps

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05 The Practice Interviewer

JOB SEARCH

Rehearse out loud with a patient interviewer who gives real feedback.

Act as an interviewer for a **[job title]** role at a **[type of company]**. Ask me one interview question at a time — mix of behavioral and role-specific. After each answer, tell me what worked, what was weak, and show me a stronger version using my own details. Don't move to the next question until I say "next."

You get: A mock interview with feedback on every answer

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Try it with voice mode on your phone. Answering out loud is much closer to the real thing.



06 The Hard Email

EVERYDAY WORK

For the message you've been putting off: asking for a raise, pushing back, saying no.

Help me write an email to **[who — e.g. my manager / a landlord / a client]**. Situation: **[what happened]**. What I want: **[the outcome]**. Give me 2 versions — one direct, one softer — each under 150 words. Sound like a calm, confident person, not a corporate robot.

You get: Two ready-to-send versions of the email

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07 Mess to Action List

EVERYDAY WORK

Meeting notes, voice memos, a chaotic group chat — turned into who does what by when.

Below are my messy notes from **[a meeting / a phone call / my brain dump]**. Turn them into: (1) a 3-sentence summary, (2) a list of action items with who owns each and any deadline mentioned, (3) open questions nobody answered. If something's unclear, flag it instead of guessing. Notes: **[paste]**

You get: Summary, owned action items, open questions

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08 Plan My Week (For Real)

LIFE

A schedule built around your actual energy and obligations, not an ideal robot's.

Help me plan next week. Fixed commitments: **[work hours, kids' pickups, appointments]**. Things I need to get done: **[list]**. I have the most energy **[mornings / evenings]**. Build a realistic day-by-day plan with buffer time, put the hardest task where my energy is highest, and tell me what to drop if the week goes sideways.

You get: A day-by-day plan with buffer time

Copy it: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p8

09 The Decision Helper

LIFE

Stuck between options? Get the angles you haven't considered — without it deciding for you.

I'm deciding between **[option A]** and **[option B]**. What matters most to me: **[e.g. money, time with family, stability]**. Lay out the pros, cons, and hidden costs of each, then tell me what would have to be true for each option to be the right call. Ask me anything you need to know. Don't pick for me — help me see it clearly.

You get: Pros, cons, hidden costs and deciding factors

Copy it: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p9



10 The Honest Critic

ANY TASK

AI is polite by default. This makes it tell you what's actually wrong — then fix it.

Here's something I wrote: **[paste — resume, post, email, essay]**. Its goal is **[what it needs to do]**. Be a tough but fair editor: list the 3 biggest problems in order of importance, explain why each one hurts, then give me a revised version that fixes them. Don't soften the feedback.

You get: The 3 biggest problems, then a fixed version

Copy it: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p10

03 · PUT IT TO WORK

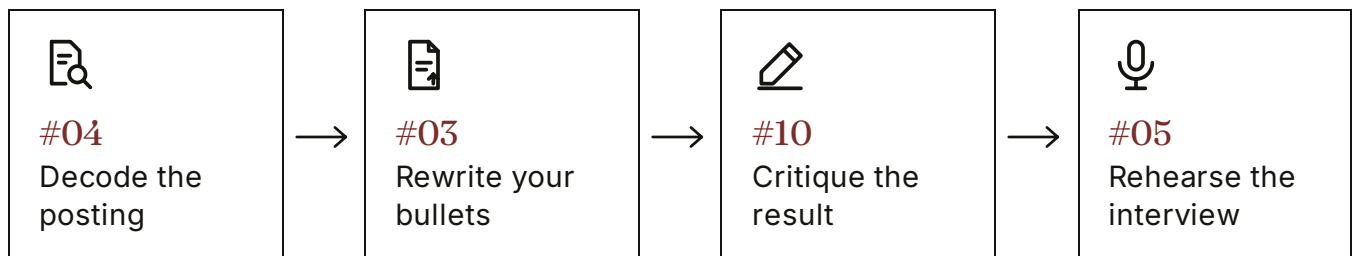
Your first ten minutes

Don't read all ten. Do one. You'll see the whole point of this kit in ten minutes.

- 1 Open** whichever AI you already have — the free version is fine.
- 2 Paste Prompt #01** and fill it in with something real from your week.
- 3 Answer** its questions honestly. Short answers are fine.
- 4 Refine** it by replying once with a fix-it line from the cheat sheet.
- 5 Compare** it with what a one-line question would have given you.

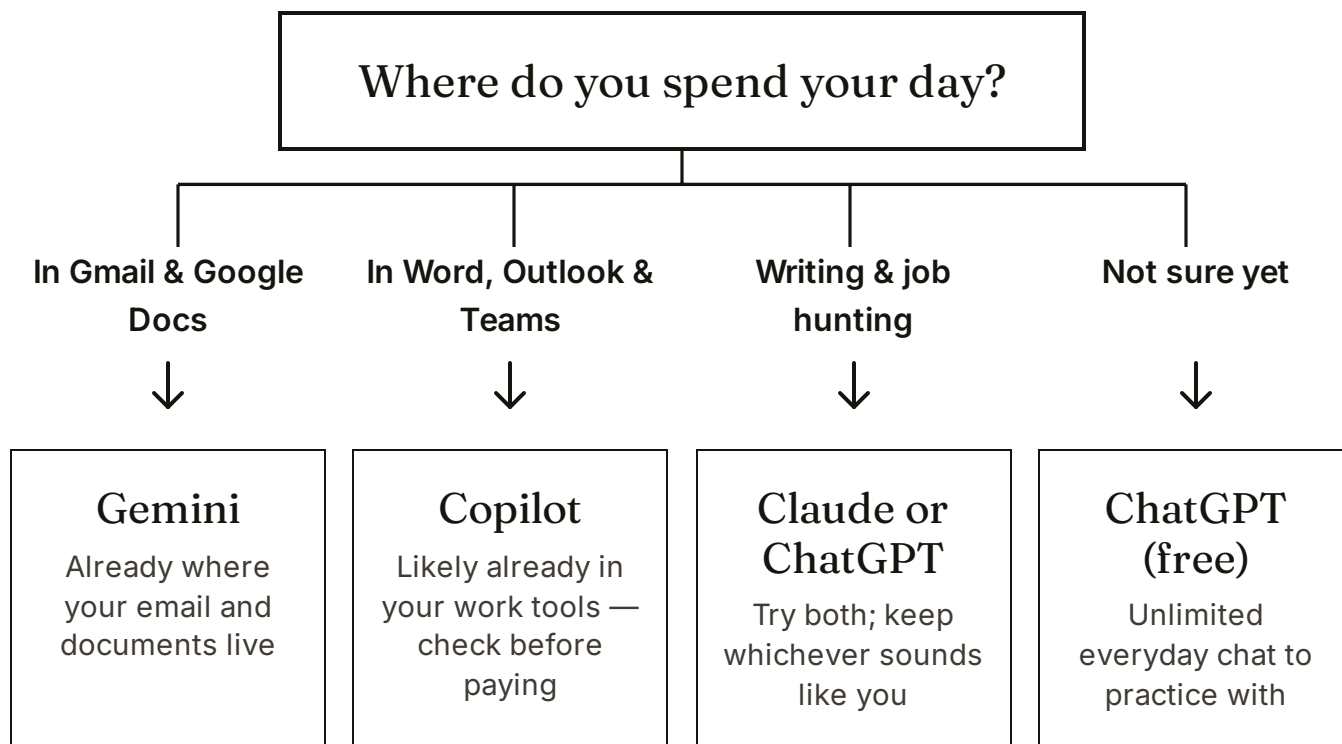
Then stack them

The real power move is chaining prompts together. For a job application, that's one afternoon instead of several evenings:



Which AI is right for you?

All four are good. Start free, pick the one you'll actually open every day, and pay only when you keep hitting the limits.



STILL NOT SURE? TRY THIS ONCE

Paste the exact same prompt into two different AI tools and read the answers side by side. You'll see right away which one thinks and writes the way you like — that's your tool.

Privacy, always: never paste passwords, account numbers or your Social Security number into any AI tool, and check your settings for whether chats are used to train the model.

What each one costs

	ChatGPT	Claude	Gemini	Copilot
MADE BY	OpenAI	Anthropic	Google	Microsoft
BEST AT	All-rounder; images; voice	Human-sounding writing; long documents	Gmail, Docs and Google search	Word, Excel, Outlook, Teams
FREE PLAN	Unlimited everyday chat; extras capped	Message cap that resets every few hours	Limits that reset every few hours	Free Copilot chat
CHEAPEST UPGRADE	Go · \$8/mo	Pro · \$20/mo (\$17/mo billed yearly)	AI Plus · \$4.99/mo	Microsoft 365 Personal · \$9.99/mo
MAIN PAID PLAN	Plus · \$20/mo	Pro · \$20/mo	AI Pro · \$19.99/mo	Microsoft 365 Premium · \$19.99/mo
WATCH OUT FOR	Ads on free & Go in the US	Free cap arrives fast on busy days	Free limits reset every 5 hours, plus a weekly cap	Copilot inside Word and Excel needs a paid Microsoft 365 plan

Prices and limits as of September 2026. AI companies change plans often — check the official pricing page before you pay.

When is it worth paying?

Stay free if... You use AI a few times a week You're still finding which tool you like You rarely see a "limit reached" message	Consider paying if... You hit the limit more than twice a week You're uploading long documents or files It's saving you an hour or more each week
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Rule of thumb: pay for **one** tool, not three — the one you open most.

One ordinary week, five hours back

Meet Dana — an example, not a real person. She manages a small office, is quietly job hunting and has two kids. Nothing fancy: just the prompts in this kit.

Estimated time saved in one week



About **4 hours 45 minutes** — an evening with her kids, every week.

Mon A hard email to a vendor — Prompt #06, two minutes instead of twenty. (Three more by Friday.)

Tue Messy meeting notes into action items — Prompt #07.

Wed A job posting decoded and her resume tailored — #04 and #03, one lunch break.

Thu Interview rehearsal in the car, parked, voice mode — #05.

Sun Soccer practice, a dentist visit and two deadlines into a real plan — #08.

Keep this by your screen

The formula

Role — “Act as a...” · **Context** — who, what, why · **Task** — one clear job · **Format** — length, layout, tone

Power phrases

“Ask me questions first.”

“Give me three options.”

“Show before and after.”

“Don’t invent facts — ask me.”

“Sound like a real person.”

Fix-it replies

Too long? “Cut this in half.”

Too generic? “Make it specific to me.”

Too stiff? “Say it like a friend.”

Too polite? “Be blunt.”

Nearly right? “Just change ____.”

Never paste in

Passwords or login codes

SSN, bank or card numbers

Your employer’s confidential information

Other people’s private details

Always double-check

Numbers, dates, statistics

Names, titles, quotes

Anything legal, medical or financial

Links — open them

The one rule

Treat the first answer as a **draft**, not a verdict. The difference between “AI is overrated” and “AI saves me hours” is usually one follow-up message.

You have the foundation. Here's where it leads.

Everything here is free and stays free. What comes next is built for everyday life.

Free

YOU ARE HERE

The AI Starter Kit

The formula, ten prompts, the tool guide and the cheat sheet — plus short emails with one new technique at a time.

\$27

PLAYBOOK

The Everyday AI Playbook

Fifty-plus prompts that each produce something you can use — a budget, a meal plan, a trip itinerary, a side-income plan, a resume, a study guide — organized by the parts of life they help with.

COMING SOON

Next

SHAPED BY
YOU

Deeper guides and one-on-one help

Focused playbooks for moments like job hunting and side income, plus personal help building exactly what you need.

LATER

HELP DECIDE WHAT COMES NEXT

Reply to your welcome email and tell me what you most want AI to help with. The next guide gets built around the answers.

STAY CLOSE

Follow [@argateway](#) on TikTok for a new prompt, walkthrough or tool comparison every day. Found this useful? Send it to one person who's still using AI like a search engine.